

PRESS RELEASE

June 2026

Report to the Flemish Parliament

Court of Audit: Renewed Integrated Investment Programme (IIP) does not today meet objectives

In 2018, Flanders launched the IIP, the Integrated Investment Programme, within the policy domain of Mobility and Public Works. The IIP aims to consolidate infrastructure investments from the various entities within that policy domain in order to allocate resources more intelligently across different modes of transport. The 2024 Flemish Government Agreement introduced a renewed IIP process. Because this renewed IIP did not start until 2024, the Court of Audit opted for a real-time audit. This gives the Flemish Government the opportunity to make timely adjustments. The audit reveals that the IIP, although pursuing relevant goals and despite the efforts of the policy domain of Mobility and Public Works, is currently not a well-developed instrument for effectively integrating Flemish investments in various modes of transport. Its update in 2026 also failed to bring about any substantial improvement. There are several significant problems. For instance, the IIP is not supported by a clear regulatory framework and there is insufficient central steering. Furthermore, objective project prioritization is lacking, and the IIP offers insufficient investment certainty. The IIP contains overly optimistic budgets and does not function as a reliable follow-up instrument.

Insufficient long-term vision and direction

The Court of Audit found that the regulatory framework on which the IIP is based is currently insufficiently robust. In practice, the IIP follows internal framework notes, but the entities do not always apply them consistently. To date, clear, enforceable, and transparent rules for the efficient implementation of the IIP are lacking. The newly established investment unit within the Department of Mobility and Public Works has insufficient mandate and capacity to fulfil its directing role, resulting in a lack of strong central substantive steering. For instance, no uniform methodology was imposed to estimate project costs, and the assessment frameworks for evaluating various investments were not applied consistently. Furthermore, there is no clear long-term vision for Flemish infrastructure policy, and the policy objectives are formulated too vaguely.

No objective project prioritization

The way in which Flemish Government makes choices within the IIP is also open to improvement. Currently, the IIP lacks objective, well-considered, and transparent project prioritization and selection. Various implementing entities within the Department of Mobility and Public Works submit investment programs, but coordination between them remains limited. The assessment frameworks, which are intended to enable careful and objective project prioritization, are also applied incompletely. The IIP proposal submitted by the investment unit based on these assessment frameworks subsequently undergoes numerous adjustments, shifts, and changes at various decision-making levels. The IIP is also insufficiently binding. Entities are allowed to deviate from it within a certain margin and can therefore execute projects that have not been assessed, have not been selected, or have lower priority.

No stable, multi-year framework

In practice, the IIP therefore did not develop into the envisioned stable, multi-year framework that creates investment certainty. It offers a perspective for only three years instead of five, and the update in 2026 is limited to that year alone. As a result, the investment agenda remains insufficiently predictable for the implementing entities and partners. The timing of the IIP updates, particularly regarding the budget adjustment, also means that the investing entities remain in uncertainty for a long time.

Unrealistic budgeting

Moreover, the IIP relies on optimistic budgeting and sometimes provides for budgets that are too low. This puts subsequent implementation under pressure. Furthermore, the future policy scope of the IIP is already partially limited by established long-term projects (including the *Alliance for the Future*) and obligations arising from major projects that have already been executed. The IIP does not start from a systematic weighing of the total financing needs against the actual available resources. The IIP funds for the period 2025-2027 are already insufficient to cover the structural investment needs. Although annual budgets rose to an average of 2.5 billion euros, this increase is barely reflected in additional investment capacity due to inflation.

No reliable follow-up instrument

Finally, the IIP currently does not function as a reliable monitoring, follow-up, and accountability instrument. The investment unit monitors the IIP primarily at the project level and, moreover, does not have sufficient high-quality data at its disposal for this purpose. Furthermore, multi-year financial follow-up is lacking, and there is no historical insight into outstanding commitments. Finally, there is no robust evaluation culture.

Conclusions of the Court of Audit

The Court of Audit therefore concludes that the IIP, although it pursues relevant objectives, is currently not a high-performing instrument for effectively integrating Flemish investments in various modes of transport. The 2026-2029 update process also brought no substantial improvement in this regard. The IIP offers insufficient guarantees for a coherent, controlled, and transparent implementation of the investment policy and fails to fulfil its function as a reliable multi-year steering instrument. To date, Flemish Government has therefore not yet succeeded in realizing its ambition to make the renewed IIP a fully-fledged planning, steering, and accountability instrument.

Response from the minister

In a joint response, the Flemish minister of Mobility and Public Works and the secretary-general of the department acknowledge that the recommendations of the Court of Audit provide useful starting points for further shaping the high ambitions of the Flemish Government Agreement with the IIP 2.o.

Information for the press

The Court of Audit exerts an external control on the financial operations of the Federal State, the Communities, the Regions and the provinces. It contributes to improving public governance by transmitting to the parliamentary assemblies, to the managers and to the audited services any useful and reliable information resulting from a contradictory

examination. As a collateral body of the Parliament, the Court performs its missions independently of the authorities it controls.

The report about the *Flemish Integrated Investment Programme* has been sent to the Flemish Parliament. The full version and this press release can be found on the Court's website: **www.courtofaudit.be**.